

JAMES WILLIAM HARRISON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with 14 years of experience building scalable backend systems and leading technical architecture decisions. I've spent the last 8 years at mid to large-scale companies working on distributed systems, cloud infrastructure, and mentoring engineering teams. I'm particularly interested in solving performance problems and helping other engineers level up their technical skills.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Java, SQL, Bash

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Docker, Kubernetes

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB

Tools and Platforms: Terraform, CI/CD pipelines, Prometheus, ELK Stack, gRPC

Architecture: Microservices, Event-driven systems, API design, Database optimization

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Vertigo Systems Ltd

vertigo-systems.io

Liverpool, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Led the design and implementation of a new event streaming platform handling 500K events per second, reducing latency by 65% compared to previous system

Mentored 6 junior and mid-level engineers through formal technical mentorship program, with 3 promoted to senior roles

Established architectural standards and code review practices across 4 engineering teams, improving code quality metrics by 40%

Drove migration of monolithic services to microservices architecture using Go and gRPC, enabling 12 parallel teams to work independently

Senior Software Engineer

CloudBridge Technologies

cloudbridge.co

Manchester, United Kingdom

June 2017 - February 2021

Owned the database optimization initiative which reduced query latencies by 70% and decreased infrastructure costs by 30% annually

Built and deployed Kubernetes clusters managing 200+ microservices across staging and production environments using Terraform

Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting system using Prometheus and Grafana, reducing incident detection time from 45 minutes to 2 minutes

Developed internal tools and libraries in Python that were adopted by 40+ engineers, standardizing how the company approached common backend problems

Software Engineer

TechVenture Solutions

techventure.net

Liverpool, United Kingdom

July 2010 - May 2017

Designed and built a real-time recommendation engine processing user behavior data for 2 million daily active users, written in Java and backed by PostgreSQL

Optimized API response times from 800ms to 120ms through database indexing, query refactoring, and caching strategies using Redis

Developed and maintained continuous deployment pipeline using Jenkins and Python, reducing deployment time from 2 hours to 15 minutes

Contributed to open source projects including Redis client libraries and participated in code reviews across 12 person engineering team

EDUCATION

University of Manchester

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Graduated: June 2010

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

github.com/jwharrison/prometheus-exporter-toolkit - Go library for building Prometheus exporters with common patterns

github.com/jwharrison/postgres-migration-tool - Python utility for safe zero-downtime database migrations

github.com/jwharrison/distributed-cache-patterns - Reference implementation of caching patterns in microservices

github.com/jwharrison/grpc-gateway-examples - Practical examples of building gRPC services with HTTP gateway